

“LUCKY VICTOR”

PAGE ONE (seven panels)

Panel 1. 1988 lower Manhattan skyline. Night.

CAPTION:
NEW YORK CITY 1988

Panel 2. The gritty streets of SOHO are littered with costumed people laughing in the night. A light mist of rain falls upon them.

CAPTION:
HALLOWEEN

Panel 3. Costumed people pass a dark alley. A black Buick is parked in the alleyway. A dark figure sits at the wheel.

Panel 4. VICTOR RODRIGUEZ sits behind the steering wheel. He is a broad man, mustached, with thick-framed glasses. He sits partially cloaked in shadow, holding a steaming paper coffee cup too his lips.

Panel 5. Close-up of Victor's lower face as he winces pulling the cup away from his mouth.

RODRIGUEZ:
Agh, too sweet.

Panel 6. Rodriguez sets the coffee cup in the cup holder. A Polaroid camera, binoculars and a dirty magazine can be seen sitting on the passenger seat beside him. A distorted voice crackles from the police radio in the dash.

DISPATCH:
334 state your 20. Repeat 334 what's your twenty. Hey Rodriguez wake up-

Panel 7. Victor shuts the radio off.

SFX:
Click

PAGE TWO

Panel 1: Victor puts a cigarette to his lips and reaches in his pocket for a lighter.

Panel 2: A close-up of his illuminated face, as he lights the cigarette.

Panel 3. From his perspective, through the windshield he watches the crowd passing the alley. A flash of red light can be seen in one of the windows in the building across the street.

Panel 4: He grabs the binoculars from the seat next to him.

Panel 5. He holds them to his face. The cigarette is still between his fingers.

Panel 6: Through the lenses he focuses on the darkened third floor windows. They are empty.

Panel 7. He removes the binoculars from his perplexed face.

PAGE THREE (eight panels)

Panel 1: Rodriguez steps out of the car.

Panel 2: (from behind) He walks toward the bustling sidewalk with one hand in his coat pocket the other holding the cigarette.

Panel 3: He steps into the crowd taking a drag looking up at the windows while costumed people weave back and forth around him.

Panel 4. In the windows, nothing but blackness.

Panel 5. He turns to go back to the car, one eye still on the windows.

Panel 6. One of the windows illuminates showing a bloody handprint and a flashing light.

Panel 7: Rodriguez nearly bites his cigarette in half as he recoils in surprise.

Panel 8. (from behind) He runs across the street towards the building entrance, tossing the cigarette.

PAGE FOUR (five panels)

Panel 1. Rodriguez charges into the lobby and flashes his badge at the doorman. He points up with his other hand.

RODRIGUEZ:

What apartment number is just above the entrance?

DOORMAN:

That would be G. Is there something wrong?

Panel 2. Rodriguez is already half in the elevator as he calls out to the doorman. The doorman is reaching for the phone.

RODRIGUEZ:

Call the police. Send them to 3G.

DOORMAN:

For what?

Panel 3. (from above) In the elevator Rodriguez checks his gun to make sure it's loaded.

Panel 4. On the third floor Rodriguez exits the elevator and looks to his left. The door to apartment 3G is open.

Panel 5. He approaches the door keeping close to the wall, his gun in one hand.

PAGE FIVE (six panels)

Panel 1. The doorknob is broken and lying on the floor in front of the door.

Panel 2 : Rodriguez peeks into the darkened loft.

Panel 3. Light from the tall windows silhouettes the swanky modern furniture.

Panel 4. He enters and moves through the living room keeping low, with his gun pointed up.

Panel 5. Before him, an end table is knocked over and a vase is broken on the floor.

Panel 6. As he kneels to study the vase, a thud resounds from behind him.

SFX:

THUD

PAGE SIX (five panels)

Panel 1. Rodriguez swings around and points his gun.

Panel 2. Down at the end of a corridor is the bedroom door. An ominous light is coming from inside the bedroom silhouetting the door.

Panel 3. (from the front) Rodriguez lowers his gun and heads down the corridor. A constant hissing runs along the bottom of the panel.

SFX:

ssssssssssss

Panel 4. (from behind) Rodriguez stands before the door. The hiss is getting louder.

SFX:

ssssssSSSSSS

Panel 5. A close-up of Rodriguez's face as he listens at the door. He is sweating profusely. The sound of someone crying is coming from inside the room.

ALLEN (OP weak):

ah huf ugh hiff

PAGE SEVEN

Panel 1. View from Rodriguez's perspective as he pushes open the door. The light illuminates a pair of legs on the floor at the foot of the bed, the rest of the body is obscured by the door frame.

Panel 2. In the foreground, a darkened male figure lies face down on the floor with his face buried in his hands. He is naked and hairy except for his balding head. In the background Rodriguez is seen in the doorway.

ALLEN:
ugh huff huff

Panel 3. Rodriguez is beside the man, reaching out and touching his shoulder as he looks around the room.

RODRIGUEZ (whisper):
Hey, I'm a cop. Are you alone?

ALLEN:
guh huff uh

RODRIGUEZ (whisper)
What was that? Are you injured?

Panel 4. A close-up of Allen as Rodriguez turns him over. His mouth is twisted in agony. His eyes have been gouged out. Streams of blood pour down the sides of his face from the two open cavities. Pools of blood cover his hands.

PAGE EIGHT (five panels)

Panel 1. Rodriguez recoils in horror, covering his mouth and falling back onto his ass.

Panel 2. , his face droops in stupefied awe as his eyes look up.

Panel 3. He begins to stand up as he looks at the wall above the bed. Abstracted geometric lines can be seen painted in red and dripping on the wall (ELDERS SIGIL).

Panel 4: Close-up of his face has he studies the pattern looking frightened and perplexed.

Panel 5. Wide shot of Rodriguez standing before the pattern which stretches the height of the ten-foot wall. The room has disappeared and all that remains are the symbol and Rodriguez with his hand on his head.

RODRIGUEZ (weak):
Jesus Christ.

PAGE NINE (four panels)

Panel 1. Victor holds his hand to his head. A hissing growl resounds beside him. His eyes look toward the sound almost comically.

SFX:

Sssnnnnnnrrrr

Panel 2. Rodriguez points his gun at two red glowing eyes in a dark corner of the room.

RODRIGUEZ:

NYPD! Step forward with your hands in the air.

Panel 3. A silhouetted figure of a naked woman can be seen.

Panel 4. Rodriguez looks almost sinister, squinting behind the sight of his revolver and sporting a scowl and a smirk.

RODRIGUEZ:

You a working girl honey? Trick wouldn't pay? Step forward, nice and slow.

Panel 5. The female figure extends a black hand with long pointed fingers. Her hair seems to digitize into the air. Her face, cloaked in darkness bears only a twisted corpse-like trapezoidal mouth filled with needle-thin teeth and a pair of red glowing eyes. Another hissing growl resounds.

SFX:

Sssnnnnnnrrrr

PAGE TEN (four panels)

Panel 1. A large hellish creature lunges from the darkness at Rodriguez. It is a devilish, twisted thing with many eyes and teeth. He fires his gun at it three times. The bullets send ripples into the beast but it unfazed

SFX:

Blam! Blam! Blam!

Panel 2. Two skeletal clawed hands grab Rodriguez by his wrists spreading them apart. The gun falls out of his hand as he looks at it in terror and awe.

Panel 3. A long thin metallic blade slashes across Victor's midriff and his intestines spill out. He screams in agony.

RODRIGUEZ:

Yeeaaarrghhh!

Panel 4. Outside the bloodstained window on the bustling street, the crowd looks blissfully unaware.

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